

out demo versions on compact discs. Publishers and retailers ideally distributed these game demos with gaming magazines.

Developments in computers were then happening at a very fast rate: Moore's law was being followed like a religion, and soon, 3D graphics were becoming a reality. *Doom*, released in 1993, defined the FPS genre, and made the distinction between FPS and first-person perspective games clear.

The early '90s saw an improvement in the graphics quality offered by PCs—this led to the establishment of new genres and innovations in the older ones. Real-time strategy games soon underwent massive changes in gameplay and graphics. *Dune2* (1992) set the standards for other RTS games to follow. It, however, was not the first strategy game ever made—that would have to be the 1984 classic, *Ancient Art of War*.

*Alone in the Dark*, also released in 1992, led to the development of what we now call the survival horror genre. This game established a formula that spurred games such as *Resident Evil* and *Silent Hill*, which became bestsellers in both the PlayStation and Xbox formats.

Adventure games, the earliest of all game genres, also evolved as quickly as any other genre, and the newer games brought about the concept of graphical interaction into gaming and integrated it with text as well as point-and-click commands.

In 1993, a game came along that used the CD-ROM as the storage format: *Myst* was one of the first computer games to make full use of the new, high-capacity CD-ROM. The game went on to



*Alone In The Dark* was the first of the survival horror genre